

Using Badges in your Moodle Course

Badges are a great way to show students visually their progress through your course. As well, the availability of badges to earn is a fantastic way to gamify your course. Badges are similar to those found on many popular video game consoles – achieve a goal, receive a badge that shows up on your profile. As of the new Moodle, badges are now 'stackable', meaning you can set it so that students need to earn certain badges to complete other badges.

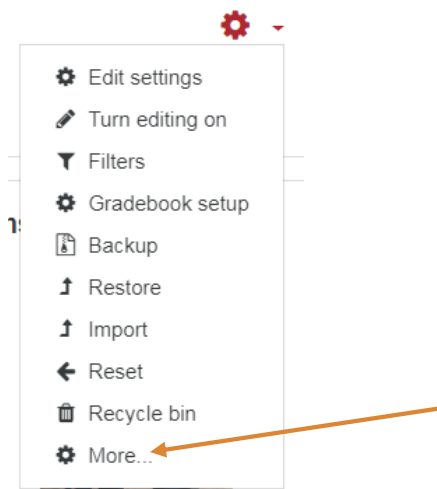
Please note: you need to have Completion Tracking enabled in your Moodle course in order to use Badges.

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Add a badge

1. Go to the course home page.
2. Click on the **Settings button** on the right side of your Moodle course page, and then click on **More** in the dropdown menu.



3. Scroll down a bit to the **Badges** section, and select **Add a new badge**.

Badges

Manage badges

Add a new badge

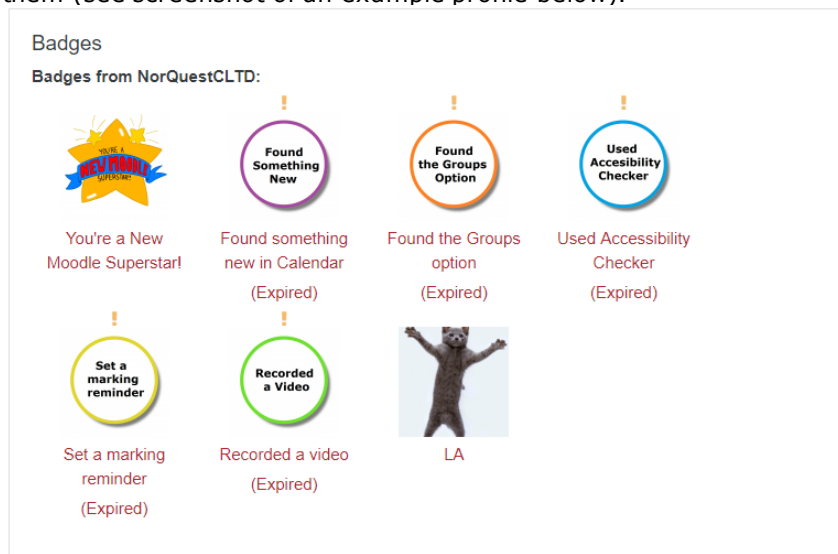
4. Give your badge a **name** and a **description** (required). The description should mention what task achieves this particular badge.

▼ Badge details

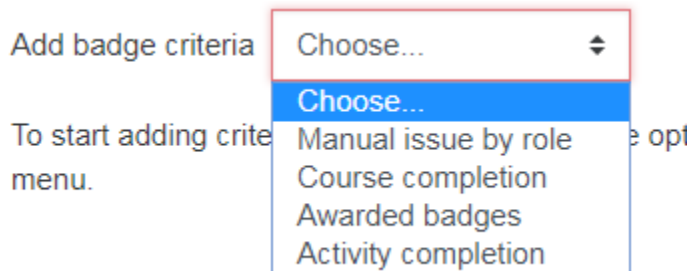
Name ⓘ

Description ⓘ

5. Drag and drop your badge image into the box with the blue arrow, or click the **Choose a file...** button. Please note that badge images can be a **maximum** of 256KB. If your image is too large (common issue), Microsoft Paint is a good program to use to shrink the image size.
6. **Badge expiry** – set the expiry date of the badge, if necessary. **NOTE:** expired badges will still show up on a student's profile. This setting really only affects badges exported into an external backpack (if this setting is turned on). Badges that have expired will have an '(expired)' tag on them (see screenshot of an example profile below).



7. When you are finished, click on **Create badge**. You will then be taken to a page where you can determine the criteria needed to earn a badge. You can also reach this page by clicking on the **Criteria** tab.
8. Select the badge criteria type by selecting from the dropdown menu under **Add badge criteria**. You will then be able to set the parameters for earning the badge on the page after, depending on what type of criteria you choose.



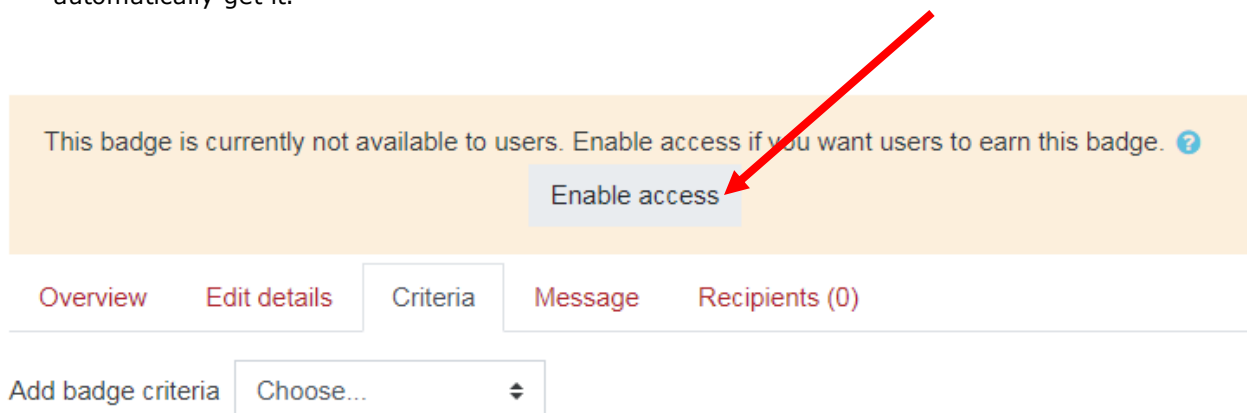
Manual issue by role – the badge is manually issued to a student by the instructor.

Course completion – the badge is issued automatically after the student has satisfied all the requirements for completing the course on Moodle (ie. Achieving a certain grade, for example, 65% in the course).

Awarded badges – new in Moodle, this option allows you to select the badges needed to complete the badge you are currently building.

Activity completion – the badge is issued automatically after the student has satisfied all the requirements for completing specified activities on Moodle (eg. completing all Unit 1 activities).

9. Click **Save** when you are done.
10. You will then be taken back to the **Criteria** page. Here, you will have to **Enable access** to the badge before it will work properly. Click on the **Enable access** button. Click **Continue** to confirm. If there are students in your course who already meet the requirements for this badge, they will automatically get it.

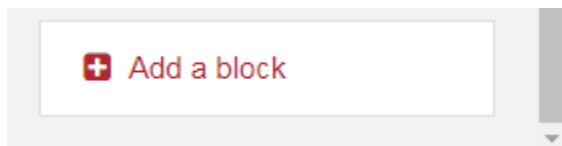


11. If you would like to edit the message that students will get emailed to them when they achieve this badge, you can do so by clicking on the **Message** tab.
12. If you would like to see a list of students who have received this badge, click on **Recipients**.

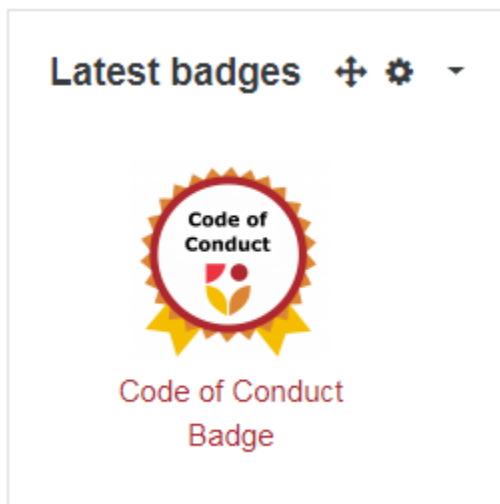
Create a Latest Badges block

It is recommended to create a Latest Badges block so students can see the badge they have just earned right away.

1. Turn editing on, if you haven't already
2. On the left hand side of your course page, open the **Navigation pane** and locate the **Add a block** block at the bottom.



3. Select **Latest badges** from the popup menu.
4. Students will now have a block in the course where they can see the badges they have earned. This block will grow in size as badges are added.



For more information contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca.